

Workflow Outline

Batch Financial Report Processing for VAs, Part 1: Extraction

Every VA who has manually extracted archive after archive, re-entering the same password each time, will recognize the problem this workflow solves. This outline shows the five-stage path from that grind to a completed batch run in minutes. Each stage lists what the VA does and what, if anything, requires client input first.

Stage 1: Decision Boundaries

The VA learns which settings must come from the client (archive password, file naming pattern, delivery location) before touching the tool at all.

Stage 2: One-Time Setup

The VA runs a single setup script that installs Python, 7-Zip, and py7zr automatically. No manual downloads, no command line typing, no prior technical background needed.

Stage 3: Configuration

The VA opens the tool and fills in: source folder, destination folder, temporary folder, the client-provided password, and which archive format to search for (or "ALL Supported" to search every format at once).

Stage 4: Processing

The VA clicks Start. The tool finds every matching archive under the source folder regardless of how it's organized, extracts each one using the right method for its format, and copies matching files into one destination folder, with a live log and file counts.

Stage 5: Verification

The VA checks the destination folder and the log for errors before marking the batch as complete, and knows exactly which issues to escalate to the client versus resolve alone.

What Makes This Guide Different

- Includes a working, tested software tool, not just written instructions.
- Supports six archive formats (RAR, ZIP, 7Z, TAR, TAR.GZ, GZ) through one interface, instead of being limited to a single format.
- Explicitly separates VA-level decisions from owner-level decisions, so the guide is usable without ongoing supervision for the routine parts.
- Setup requires no prior technical knowledge. One double-click and the VA has everything installed.
- Built from a real production process that ran for years processing thousands of records, adapted into a generic, reusable form.